Employer Outreach Playbook

For a temporary staffing agency building employer accounts in Northeast Arkansas | Research checked October 12, 2026

This guide uses editable placeholders where the agency's capabilities, rates, operating model, past placements, and references were not provided. Replace a placeholder only with a verified statement.

1. Position the agency around the job order

The employer is not buying a generic candidate list. The agency earns trust by understanding a specific role, presenting candidates who meet agreed requirements, communicating attendance and performance issues quickly, and handling its agreed payroll, screening, safety coordination, and billing work consistently.

Before outreach, write one accurate sentence for each: roles filled; recruiting geography; typical response window if evidenced; screening actually performed; background/drug/reference process if offered; payroll and employer-of-record arrangement; workers' compensation/insurance; after-hours coverage; replacement terms; invoice and payment terms; and references the agency is allowed to disclose.

2. First-call script

> *Hello, this is [name] with [agency]. We provide [verified role categories] in [verified area]. I saw [specific public role or local employer signal] and wanted to ask one quick question: does your site use temporary staffing for coverage or workload peaks, or are those positions direct hire only?*

If they say they may use outside help: "What roles or shifts are hardest to cover, and who handles supplier approval?" Then ask for a short discovery conversation. Do not start by promising fill speed or availability.

If the public listing may be stale: "I may be looking at an older public listing, so I wanted to verify before assuming anything. Is this role still open?"

If they say no: thank them, ask whether a future seasonal period or role category is relevant, and record whether they asked for a later follow-up.

3. Discovery checklist

1. What specific operational event created the need: vacancy, leave, seasonality, backlog, new line, project, or unpredictable volume?

2. Which job title, duties, site, supervisor, shift, days, start date, assignment length, headcount, and expected weekly hours?

3. What is the worker pay range/basis and which differentials, overtime, holidays, or travel rules apply? Who confirms these details?

4. Which experience, certifications, physical requirements, language, equipment skills, tests, background, drug, reference, or license checks are required? Which checks may the agency perform, and which remain with the host?

5. What hazards exist? Who provides site/task-specific orientation, PPE, machine training, emergency instructions, injury reporting, and hazard-change updates?

6. Who approves time, resolves attendance/performance issues, authorizes overtime, and can change work duties?

7. Do you accept new staffing vendors? What legal entity, insurance limits, indemnity, safety documents, audit, onboarding, purchase order, and system requirements apply?

8. What are the invoice cadence, time approval deadline, payment terms, dispute process, conversion/placement terms, cancellation rules, and any service-level expectations?

4. Job-order acceptance gate

Do not recruit until the agency can state the role, location, schedule, pay basis, client contact, required screening, worksite hazards, safety handoff, start date, supplier approval, bill rate, payment terms, and a realistic candidate supply plan. Decline or pause if the role is outside her proven recruiting ability, the worksite/hazards are unclear, legal/employer responsibilities cannot be explained, expected collections cannot cover payroll, or the client will not document the assignment.

5. Questions employers may ask

What roles do you staff?

We currently focus on [verified roles] in [verified geography]. For a role outside that range, I would rather confirm our recruiting capacity before saying yes.

How quickly can you fill this?

I can give you a realistic update after I review the schedule, requirements, pay range and available candidate pool. I don't promise a fill date before checking those details.

What is your rate or markup?

It depends on pay, payroll/insurance burden, shift, screening, schedule, payment terms and job requirements. I can quote a written bill rate after we confirm those inputs. Markup and gross margin are different, and our quote covers the actual costs of this job.

What screening do you do?

We perform [only checks actually performed], with [verified consent/process]. You will receive the agreed result or status, not unnecessary sensitive data. Site-specific qualification remains as agreed in the job order.

Who employs and pays the worker?

Our arrangement is [state the actual employer/payroll model and legal entity]. I can provide the applicable contract and confirm any detail with our payroll/legal adviser before we proceed.

Who handles safety?

We will document the division of responsibilities for each assignment and coordinate before work starts. We need your site hazards, orientation, PPE, supervisor, and injury/near-miss process. We do not treat the contract as a substitute for legal duties.

Can you share past results or references?

If she has an authorized comparable example: share only verified, permission-approved details. If not: 'I don't have a comparable case I can disclose. I can walk you through our recruiting and onboarding process and, if the job fits, start with one clearly defined order and agreed service measures.' Never invent a client, placement, fill rate, retention figure, or reference.

Can you guarantee attendance or retention?

No staffing provider can responsibly promise that without a defined and supportable service term. We can agree on check-ins, escalation, reporting and any written replacement remedy after reviewing the assignment and economics.

Do you have workers ready now?

I need to check real availability, qualifications and consent before telling you a candidate is available. I will not present a person as screened or committed until that is confirmed.

6. Common objections

We already use agencies.

That makes sense. Are there roles or shifts your current suppliers do not cover, and is your vendor list open to another qualified local supplier? If not, thank them and do not press.

We hire directly.

Understood. Is there any leave, seasonal, project or short-term coverage where a separate approach would make sense, or is direct hire the only model you want?

Send information.

Of course. Which role family or service requirement should I make the overview relevant to? Who is the right person to receive it, and when would a brief follow-up be useful?

Your bill rate is too high.

Let's compare the same pay, shift, screening, insurance, service and payment terms. If the economics do not work on either side, we should not force an order.

We need people tomorrow.

I will check candidate availability and every requirement first. If we cannot verify a safe, qualified match, I will say so rather than promise a start we cannot support.

We need a guarantee.

Let's define the outcome, reporting, escalation and any remedy that can be supported by the contract and rate. I will not promise a fill or retention metric before confirming capability.

7. Follow-up messages

After a useful call: Subject: staffing follow-up - [role/site]. Thanks for outlining the [role/shift] need at [site]. I understand [briefly restate the confirmed need]. I will confirm [candidate supply / vendor documents / cost inputs] by [date]. Could you send or confirm [missing facts]? I will not send candidates until we confirm the job order and supplier process.

After 'send information': Subject: [agency] overview - [role category]. Thanks for speaking with me. Attached is a brief overview limited to [verified role types and geography]. Is [person/team] the right contact for contingent-labor approval? If useful, I can follow up [specific date the contact agreed to].

No answer: follow up once with a concise note referencing the relevant role or question, then pause unless they invited more contact. Respect opt-outs and the employer's preferred channel.

8. Price from actual cost; do not use a guessed local markup

For an hourly temporary assignment, calculate the direct hourly cost from actual worker wage, employer payroll tax/unemployment burden, workers' compensation cost by the correct classification, benefits, recruiting/screening and administration, and any other assignment-specific direct costs. Add a risk allowance only with a documented basis. If the target is gross margin on billings, bill rate = total cost per paid hour / (1 - target gross margin). Gross margin = (bill rate - cost) / bill rate. Markup = (bill rate - cost) / cost. These are not interchangeable.

Then review overtime/differentials, expected hours, client payment lag, payroll cash capacity, replacement/cancellation terms, payment risk, insurance exclusions, and whether a project or seasonal assignment has uncertain hours. The workbook's Rate Model is blank by design. The agency's actual costs and target margin have not been provided.

Never set a price from public wage averages alone. Local wage data can help ask whether the expected wage is plausible; it cannot determine her payroll burden, insurance, worker supply, client bill rate, or margin.

9. Staffing safety and compliance handoff

Before any placement, document the exact task, site, hazards, client supervisor, agency and host safety responsibilities, training/orientation, PPE, emergency procedures, injury/near-miss notice, and who confirms training completion. OSHA guidance describes shared staffing-agency/host responsibilities; details depend on facts. Confirm arrangements with counsel/insurance adviser and do not tell a client that contracting away tasks removes legal obligations.

Arkansas Act 438 of 2025 repealed the Private Employment Agency Act and related occupational-licensure provisions described in the bill. It does not answer every business, labor, tax, insurance, workers' compensation, safety, contract, or industry-specific requirement. Verify the agency's exact model with Arkansas counsel and qualified payroll/tax/insurance professionals. A temp arrangement may raise joint-employer issues under wage/hour law.

10. Source register

Paragould Jobs - local employer vacancies - Official city/economic-development page; describes itself as regularly updated. Roles are shown as of the research check, not verified as still open with each employer.

Greene County Manufacturing Directory - Official directory listing business type, address and public main phone for many Paragould manufacturers/distributors.

Paragould / Greene County Largest Employers - Employer size bands for Greene County, not necessarily a single facility headcount.

Jonesboro MSA major employers and existing industries - Jonesboro Unlimited industry guide. Employment figures are regional guide figures, may not equal a specific facility or current payroll. Page includes 2026 manufacturing announcements.

Jonesboro MSA advanced manufacturing workforce - Reports 10,000+ manufacturing/production workers and 2026 occupational wage anchors; context only, not evidence a named employer uses temps.

Unilever Jonesboro Machine Operator posting - Employer-posted full-time direct-hire listing dated 2026-09-30 through 2026-10-15; listing says 2nd/3rd shifts and $26.70 base, with additional details. Recheck before use.

Nestlé Jonesboro jobs and location - Employer page confirms local production facility and shows openings at research check; technical openings are not general labor evidence.

Post Consumer Brands Jonesboro role - Official job listing previously identified for a Quality and Food Safety Technician; live fetch was blocked in this run, so verify current status before mentioning.

Frito-Lay / PepsiCo Jonesboro job listing - Official job listing previously identified for General Utility Technician in Jonesboro; live fetch was blocked in this run, so verify current status before mentioning.

Hytrol careers - Company careers page; Jonesboro employment scale from regional industry guide. No specific current opening independently verified here.

Great Dane careers - Company career page. Regional guide reports local-area employment; no specific live local opening verified here.

Arkansas Act 438 / SB278 - Official Arkansas legislative record: Act 438, effective 2025-04-03, repealed the Private Employment Agency Act and related occupational authorization/licensure statutes. Do not infer other duties are absent.

OSHA guidance on temporary workers - Agency and host employer have shared safety responsibilities; allocation depends on facts. Use as a contract/job-order intake prompt, not legal advice.

OSHA communication and coordination - OSHA recommends worksite coordination, role clarity, training and hazard communication.

U.S. DOL FLSA joint employment advisor - Where joint employment exists, both employers must ensure FLSA rights. Case-specific; verify details with counsel/payroll professional.